

Spring Minestrone

with Parmesan Crisps

This bowl of Italian *minestrone*, or "big soup," is made with seasonal vegetables, white beans, and pesto. In our opinion, this classic is even better with something crunchy, so we've added homemade *fricos* (Parmesan crisps) to the equation.

25-35 minutes Serves 2 people 630 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 8 ounces leeks
- 6 ounces escarole
- 6 ounces pencil asparagus
- ⅛ ounce fresh chives
- 1 can white beans
- 1 cup pearl onions
- 16 ounces vegetable stock
- 1 cup peas
- ½ cup shredded Parmesan cheese
- 2 tablespoons pesto
- 1 parchment paper

You'll Need

- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 2 cups water
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 12" large pot
- baking sheet

Recipe Tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

If any grit remains, be sure to soak leeks in clean water again and rinse throughly.

When the Parmesan bakes, the rounds will melt and spread. Be sure to space them apart. Quickly lift them off the baking sheet when they're finished baking since the cheese is most pliable when it's hot.

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1. Prepare Ingredients

Preheat oven to 375°F. Rinse **leeks** and trim and discard dark green tops. Halve lengthwise, then cut crosswise into ¼-inch slices and place in a bowl of cold water, allowing dirt to sink to bottom. Rinse remaining produce. Tear **escarole** into bite-size pieces. Trim and discard woody ends of **asparagus** and cut into 1-inch pieces. Thinly slice **chives**. Drain **white beans** and rinse.



2. Sauté Vegetables

Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a large pot over medium heat. Remove **leeks** from water (see Recipe Tip). When oil is shimmering, add **pearl onions**, **leeks**, and **asparagus**. Season with **¼ teaspoon kosher salt** and **pepper** as desired. Sauté, stirring, until vegetables are softened, 5-7 minutes.



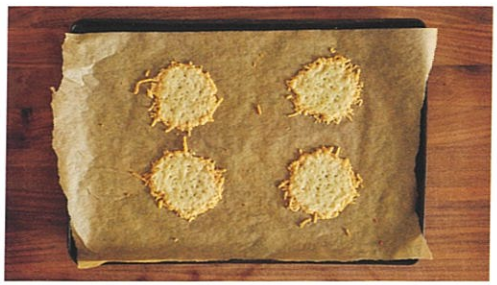
3. Simmer Soup

Add **vegetable stock**, **white beans**, and **2 cups water** to pot with vegetables. Increase heat to high and bring to a boil, then reduce heat to medium and simmer, stirring, until flavors are melded, about 6 minutes. Add **peas** and **escarole** and cook, stirring occasionally until bright green, about 2 minutes more. Remove pot from heat.



4. Prepare Parmesan Crisps

While soup simmers, on a parchment-lined baking sheet, arrange **Parmesan** in 4 piles, about 1½-inches wide.



5. Bake Pamesan Crisps

Transfer **Parmesan** to oven and bake until golden and crisp, about 8 minutes. Remove and using a spatula, immediately loosen from parchment paper and set aside to cool until ready to use (see Recipe Tip).



6. Plate Soup

Add **pesto** and **chives** to pot with soup and stir to combine. Taste and add more **salt** and **pepper** as needed. Enjoy **minestrone** with **Parmesan crisps** on top for crunch.

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